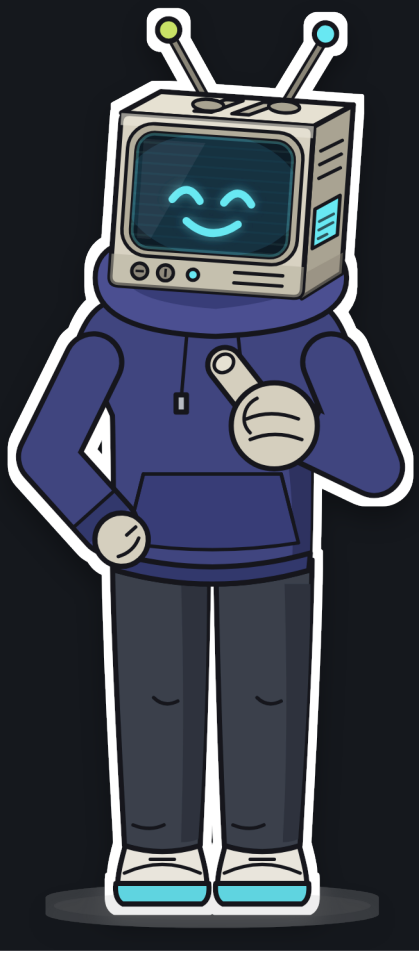
COMMENT "FRAME" BONUS

# The StickFrame Director Pack

The director notes, shot changes and video ideas from my own StickFrame videos, ready to copy and paste.

by Niklaus AI · works with the free StickFrame app
github.com/niklaus-ai-yt/stickframe



# How to use this pack

StickFrame takes notes in three places. Everything in this pack is plain English, so paste it as it is and change the names.

**1. The brief (director notes):** one short paragraph in the storyboard step, before the AI plans the shots. It sets the cast, the mood and what to show on screen. *Section A.*

**2. "Describe the change to this shot":** click any shot card in the storyboard and type what you want. Only that shot changes. *Section B.*

**3. Method 2 (the Claude app):** just type the same notes in your chat with Claude. It applies them for you.

### 7 rules from making these videos

- **Don't fix every shot.** Watch once, write down the 3 or 4 weakest shots, and change only those.
- **Tell characters apart by colour and one item.** Each character gets a signature colour. Add one item from the wardrobe list below. Things the app doesn't have (an apron, a cardigan) are ignored.
- **Ask for numbers on screen.** When the narrator says a number, a counter or a stamp was the strongest shot every time.
- **Give the mood a direction.** "Tense, then hopeful" beats "tense". The music and lighting follow it.
- **One look per channel.** People start to recognise your videos by it.
- **Preview before the full render.** A 20-second preview finds problems in seconds.
- **Long videos on a free chatbot:** go part by part (StickFrame does this for you past 75 seconds). For Shorts, choose 9:16 at the start and turn captions on.

### What StickFrame can draw (use these words)

**Looks:** Ember, Moonlight, Sketchbook, Chalkboard, Candy Pop. **Music moods:** calm, wonder, upbeat, tense, sad, epic, mystery, playful.

**Wardrobe:** hoodie, shirt, scarf, cap, beanie, tie, bow, glasses, sunglasses, headband, labcoat, dress, cape, backpack, ponytail, bun, spiky, crown, tophat, headphones, helmet, mustache, beard.

**Locations:** stage, blueprint, room, bedroom, livingroom, office, kitchen, classroom, cafe, hospital, lab, gym, hallway, street, city, rooftop, park, forest, beach, lake, pool, mountain, desert, field, road, space, sky, underwater.

**Effects:** dust, rain, snow, sparkles, confetti, hearts, bubbles, embers, money, leaves, fireflies, stars, speedlines, zoomlines, freeze, flash, shake, spotlight, heartbeat, glitch, lightning, fog, godrays, dream, night, crowd.

Plus 174 props and 60 poses. The README lists them all.

# A. Briefs that work

## The two real briefs from the video

METHOD 1, TYPED BY ME

"Alex always wears his blue cap, and Maya wears her yellow apron. Show lots of numbers on screen. Keep it tense, but hopeful."

Worked: the cap, the numbers and the mood. Didn't: StickFrame has no apron, so Maya was told apart by her colour only.

METHOD 2, WRITTEN BY CLAUDE FROM MY ANSWERS

"Mood: tense but hopeful. Days 1-2 tense and uneasy (dim, quiet, uncertain); from Day 5 onward warmer and hopeful; ending reflective. Music should follow this arc."

Worked very well: a mood that changes over the video gives the music and lighting somewhere to go.

## The formula

**Cast** (name, colour, one wardrobe item) + **mood arc** (start → end) + **what goes on screen** (numbers, maps, charts) + **one camera habit** (close-ups on surprises, slow pushes).

## 10 ready-made briefs by niche

WHAT IF · LOOK: MOONLIGHT · MUSIC: TENSE

"You (yellow, hoodie) and a neighbour (green, glasses). Start tense and dim, turn warm and hopeful in the last third. Show every big number on screen as a counter. End on the narrator's question with a slow push in."

HISTORY · LOOK: SKETCHBOOK · MUSIC: EPIC

"One main character (red, helmet) and a crowd. Use maps and dates on screen whenever a place or year is said. Wide shots for battles, close-ups for decisions. Calm, then epic at the turning point."

SCIENCE EXPLAINER · LOOK: CHALKBOARD · MUSIC: WONDER

"A curious host (blue, labcoat, glasses). Draw every idea on the board: arrows, labels and simple charts. One idea per shot. Use the lab and the classroom."

MONEY AND PERSONAL FINANCE · LOOK: CANDY POP · MUSIC: UPBEAT

"Sam (green, cap). Every amount appears on screen as a counter with a cash sound. Use charts for growth. Upbeat, never preachy. Close-up on Sam's face at each surprise."

PSYCHOLOGY · LOOK: EMBER · MUSIC: MYSTERY

"One person (orange, hoodie) and their thoughts as speech and thought bubbles. Use the bedroom, office and cafe. Freeze the frame on each 'aha' moment."

HEALTH AND BODY · LOOK: CANDY POP · MUSIC: PLAYFUL

"A narrator character (pink, headband) and a giant brain and heart as props. Show a timer or calendar whenever time passes. Light and friendly, no scary images."

MYSTERY AND TRUE-STORY STYLE · LOOK: MOONLIGHT · MUSIC: MYSTERY

"Detective (grey, tophat) with a magnifier. Night lighting, fog in outdoor scenes, spotlight on each clue. Keep the camera slow. Reveal the answer with a flash."

MOTIVATION · LOOK: EMBER · MUSIC: EPIC

"Runner (red, headband). Sunrise lighting, slow pushes in. Big words on screen for the key line of each section. Celebrate at the end with confetti."

SPACE · LOOK: MOONLIGHT · MUSIC: WONDER

"Astronaut (white, helmet). Space and sky sets, stars, a rocket and the moon. Show distances and times as big numbers. Float poses whenever there's no gravity."

TECH AND THE INTERNET · LOOK: CANDY POP · MUSIC: UPBEAT

"You (purple, headphones). Phones, laptops and wifi icons. Glitch effect whenever something breaks. Fast cuts, lots of on-screen numbers."

# B. Shot changes to copy

### The real ones from the video

S08, METHOD 1
"Make it a wide shot of Alex and Maya in the street, with a big countdown from seven down to zero."

S14, METHOD 2
"Shorten the first shot, and add a close-up on my face when the card is declined."

METHOD 2, SCRIPT
"Make the ending more personal. Ask the viewer what they'd miss the most."

### Camera

- Make it a close-up of her face when she hears the news.
- Start wide on the whole street, then push in slowly on Alex.
- Split this shot in two: first the phone, then his reaction.
- Hold the last shot two seconds longer so the question lands.

### Emotion and acting

- Make him facepalm on the word 'again'.
- She should look shocked, then laugh.
- Make the crowd cheer when the number appears.
- Have him sit on the floor, tired, for the whole sentence.

### Numbers and graphics

- Put a big counter from 0 to 5 billion on screen when the narrator says it.
- Add a chart that goes up on 'every year'.
- Slam a DECLINED stamp on the screen on 'declined'.
- Add a stopwatch counting down from 10.

### Effects and weather

- Add rain and a lightning flash on 'storm'.
- Freeze everything on the word 'stops'.
- Add a glitch when the screen goes dark.
- Confetti when they win.

### Pacing

- This shot is too long. Cut it to about two seconds.
- Too much happens here. Keep only Maya and the sign.
- Use the same location as the shot before, so it doesn't jump.

Tip: name the word the change should happen on ("on 'declined'"). StickFrame times it to that word.

# C. Tested video ideas

### Made start to finish in StickFrame

| | |
|---|---|
| **What if gravity stopped for five seconds?**<br>The demo at the start of the video: 104 s, directed by logged-out Gemini in 2 parts. | Big physical gags (floating cars, people, a dog) read instantly as stick figures. Five numbered seconds give the video its structure. |
| **Seven Days Offline (the internet shuts down for a week)**<br>Method 1: free chatbot, 1 minute, 16 shots, Moonlight. | Day-by-day countdowns make easy pattern breaks. Ask for numbers on screen: they were the strongest shots. |
| **What If the Internet Shut Down for a Week**<br>Method 2: the Claude app, 1:13, 35 shots, 8 messages. | A second-person story ('you wake up...') plus one recurring neighbour made it personal. Ending on a question invites comments. |
| **The same internet story at 190 seconds**<br>Logged-out Gemini, in 3 parts, 53 shots, rendered at 1080p in 37 s. | Long scripts work for free if you go part by part. Keep each part about a minute. |

### 30 more ideas, each checked against StickFrame

Every location, prop and effect next to an idea exists in the app, so the AI can draw every scene. Checked = it can be made, not a promise of views.

**What if you stayed awake for 11 days?**
"In 1963 a student stayed awake for 264 hours. Here's what happened to his brain each day."
bedroom · classroom · hospital · clock · brain · calendar · dream

**What if the sun vanished for one hour?**
"For eight minutes, nobody would notice anything."
city · field · space · sun · moon · stopwatch · night · stars

**What if every car stopped at the same time?**
"Rush hour. Then silence."
road · city · car · bus · bike · crowd

**What if cash disappeared overnight?**
"You reach for your wallet. It's empty, and so is everyone else's."
street · cafe · cash · wallet · coin · money

**What if you lived on the moon for a year?**
"Day one, you jump six times higher. Day 30, you miss rain."
space · room · rocket · moon · globe · battery

**What if it rained for 40 days straight?**
"Day 3 is cosy. Day 20 is not."
street · city · lake · raincloud · umbrella · boat · rain · lightning

**What if everyone could read minds?**
"The first meeting at work lasts eleven seconds."
office · classroom · thought · speech · brain · glitch

**What if you never touched your phone again?**
"Hour one: your hand keeps reaching for it."
bedroom park cafe phone book clock

**What if snow fell everywhere on Earth for a day?**
"Even in the desert."
desert beach city snowflake snow

**What if you woke up 100 years in the future?**
"Your alarm clock still works. Nothing else is the same."
bedroom city lab alarm calendar rocket

**What if all the bees disappeared?**
"Breakfast is the first thing to change."
field park flower tree apple pancakes

**What if you lived without electricity for a month?**
"Night one feels like camping. Night ten, you learn how dark night really is."
livingroom kitchen street lamp fridge campfire flashlight night

**Why your brain loves to procrastinate**
"You opened this video instead of doing that thing, didn't you?"
office bedroom brain clock phone check

**What happens if you stop eating sugar for 30 days?**
"Day three is the hardest. Here's why."
kitchen gym apple calendar heart brain

**What if everyone quit their job tomorrow?**
"Who makes your coffee on Wednesday?"
office street cafe briefcase sign crowd

**What if you could pause time for one day?**
"Everyone freezes. Except you."
city street clock hourglass freeze

**What if the ocean disappeared?**
"You could walk from New York to London. You wouldn't want to."
beach desert boat waves map

**What if you found a million dollars on the street?**
"Step one: do not post about it."
street office cash chest banknote money

**What if every door opened somewhere random?**
"You open the bathroom door and you're on the moon."
hallway door beach space forest underwater

**What if you were the last person on Earth?**
"Day one, every shop is yours. Day two, you'd give it all back for a conversation."
city street rooftop fog

**What if everyone told the truth for a week?**
"Your boss asks how you are. You tell him."
office cafe classroom speech exclaim heart

**What if you could only say 100 words a day?**
"You've already used twelve."
room cafe speech clock

**What if you lived 1,000 years ago for one day?**
"No clock, no map, no coffee."
field forest campfire tent crown

**What if your phone battery lasted forever?**
"Nobody would ever say 'my phone died' again."
street phone battery bolt

**What if the moon were twice as close?**
"Every night would look like a movie poster."
beach sky space moon waves godrays

**How $5 a day grows in 30 years**
"It's the price of a coffee. It adds up to more than you'd think."
office cafe coin chart calendar money

**What if school were only one day a week?**
"Monday is now very, very long."
classroom park bedroom whiteboard backpack

**What if humans could breathe underwater?**
"The beach gets a lot more crowded. And a lot deeper."

underwater beach pool drop swim

**What if animals could talk for one day?**
"Your dog has a lot of opinions about the vacuum."

livingroom park dog bird speech

**What if you had a twin you never knew about?**
"You walk into a cafe and someone already ordered your usual."

cafe street question cup

**Made something with this?** Post it and tell me in the comments. Get StickFrame free at https://github.com/niklaus-ai-yt/stickframe.